as weak in the eyes of the international community. The junta refused to allow former Nobel Peace Prize winners the Dalai Lama, Oscar Arias, Bishop Desmond Tutu, and Betty Williams enter Myanmar in order to meet with Suu Kyi. Their pleas for her release were of course ignored. She would later be awarded the Presidential Medal of Freedom by President Bill Clinton. A few years later the International Voices for Freedom event underscored the continued injustices in Myanmar. Artists such as U2, Paul McCartney, and REM have honored her in their music.

Suu Kyi was able to put together several publications during her incarceration. Her book *Freedom from Fear* was critically acclaimed and the proceeds from the book helped to keep her out of significant debt. Several writers interviewed Suu Kyi for publications. Ann Clemens wrote *The Voice of Hope*, based on a series of interviews conducted in the 1990s. *Letters from Burma* was a compilation of articles published by Suu Kyi. Additionally, the foreign media flocked to her residence, 54 University Avenue, in order to gain an interview or photograph of this larger than life symbol of democracy. Her calls for reconciliation with the junta were never seriously considered during this period.

On the occasions in which Suu Kyi was freed from house arrest, the junta quickly realized that she would not remain inactive or silent. The regime decided to organize well-paid gangs of thugs who operated under the name of the Union Solidarity and Development Association (USDA). They would use intimidation and violence to suppress any pro-democracy elements, NLD or others, from emerging in Myanmar. The tatmadaw continue to harass anyone suspected of opposing the government. Suu Kyi's attempts to visit areas outside of Rangoon were met with roadblocks and sometimes violent encounters with either military intelligence or members of the tatmadaw. In 1998, Suu Kyi was trapped inside of a car on two occasions, which led to her being forcibly removed from the vehicles by government authorities.

Suu Kyi's husband had been banned from visiting her in Myanmar because he supposedly smuggled her speeches out of the country on previous visits. In 1998, tragedy was to strike Suu Kyi in the most personal way. Her husband and source of strength for so many years was diagnosed with prostate cancer. His pleas to be allowed to visit his wife prior to his death fell on deaf ears. The junta probably felt this was the best opportunity